

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 5 4 3

♥ A Q 9

♦ 2

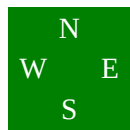
♣ 9 5 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ 6

♦ A Q 10 8 7 5

♣ A 10 6



♠ 8 6 2

♥ K J 8 5 3 2

♦ 9 4

♣ 8 2

♠ A Q

♥ 10 7 4

♦ K J 6 3

♣ K Q J 7

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a very good hand with probable slam interest. It is very tempting to say 3NT now but you don't have ♥s stopped and don't know if partner does. So with good ♦ support you bid 4♦. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠A and ♦K. But you don't have the ♦Q so you answer 5♥. Partner bids 6♦.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass        | 3♦    | Pass | 4♦    |
| Pass        | 4NT   | Pass | 5♥    |
| Pass        | 6♦    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♦ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣8    |       |      |       |

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

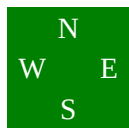
♠ A 6 5 2  
 ♥ Q J 5 2  
 ♦ K J 3  
 ♣ 8 2

♠ J 3

♥ 7

♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3



♠ K 10 8  
 ♥ A K 9 8 6 4  
 ♦ -  
 ♣ A K Q 7

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 10 3

♦ A Q 10 7

♣ 10 6 5

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
|            |       | 1♥   | Pass  |
| 3♥         | Pass  | 4♣   | Pass  |
| 4♥         | Pass  | 4NT  | Pass  |
| 5♣         | Pass  | 6♥   |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 6♥ by East |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠ 7  |       |      |       |

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠ A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠ A or the practically useless ♦ A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦ s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠ A. It looks like the slam is a good idea so you say 6♥.

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

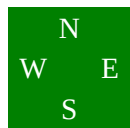
♠ 10 3  
 ♥ Q 9 2  
 ♦ K Q 8 7 5  
 ♣ 10 7 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J 10 7

♦ -

♣ A 9 8 3



♠ J

♥ A 6 5 4 3

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ 6 5 4

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1♠    |
| Pass        | 4♦    | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass        | 5NT   | Pass | 6♠    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦K    |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

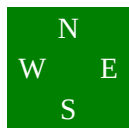
♠ K Q J  
 ♥ A 10 7 6  
 ♦ A Q J  
 ♣ Q J 9

♠ 3 2

♥ J 3 2

♦ 8 7 6 4 3

♣ 8 4 3



♠ A 10 8  
 ♥ K 9 8 4  
 ♦ K 9  
 ♣ K 10 6 5

♠ 9 7 6 5 4

♥ Q 5

♦ 10 5 2

♣ A 7 2

| West       | North | East | South |
|------------|-------|------|-------|
| 2NT        | Pass  | 3♣   | Pass  |
| 3♥         | Pass  | 4NT  | Pass  |
| 5♥         |       |      |       |
| All Pass   |       |      |       |
| 5♥ by West |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♠3   |       |      |       |

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.